

RAFAEL CARBAJAL SANCHEZ

UX / Product Designer | Available June 2027
ra.carbajalsa@gmail.com | (424) 436-9220 | Los Angeles, CA

LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/rafael-carbajal-956485285](https://www.linkedin.com/in/rafael-carbajal-956485285)

Portfolio: rafaelsanchez.design

SUMMARY

UX/product designer combining user research, UI design, and AI-assisted coding to build high-fidelity consumer app prototypes. Experience includes Snapchat local services and a deployed AI assistant.

EDUCATION

Santa Monica College - Santa Monica, CA Expected June 2027
Bachelor of Science (B.S.) in Interaction Design
Google UX Design Certificate, Coursera 2025

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Snap Inc. | Snap Design Academy - Los Angeles, CA
Design Scholar (Contract) Jun - Aug 2026

- Led UX for Resources, a Snapchat local-support concept, partnering with engineering and marketing to take an open prompt to a functional prototype in 3 weeks.
- Conducted 2 rounds of partner research and feedback with SPY and St. Joseph Center; combined findings with usability testing to refine hierarchy, privacy, and service handoffs.
- Created UI components for Resources across Snap Map, Search, Spotlight, and sharing; presented the prototype and design decisions to 300+ Snap employees.

Plataforma Impact - Mexico City, Mexico (Remote)

UX Intern Mar 2021 - Jan 2022

- Contributed UX/UI design work to 3 websites, including a B2B specialty coffee brand.
- Created Figma layouts and implemented front-end updates with senior designers on a remote team.
- Supported 1 website launch; the deployed site recorded a reported 33% sales increase.

SELECTED DESIGN PROJECTS

Pantri | Grocery Planning App Spring 2026

- Built a high-fidelity React prototype with 26 interactive screens using Figma and AI-assisted coding, covering onboarding, pantry tracking, meal planning, and completion with simulated data.
- Interviewed 13 grocery shoppers to shape flows around budgeting, substitutions, and produce selection.
- Tested Pantri in 3 rounds with 5 participants per round; prototyped recovery paths for substitutions, quantity changes, and skipped meals so users could adjust plans without restarting.

Nibble | AI Portfolio Assistant Summer 2026

- Launched an AI portfolio assistant that answered 250+ visitor questions in its first 4 weeks.
- Built contextual project routing; project views per visit rose from 1.6 to 2.3 in the first 4 weeks.
- Guided 52% of Nibble users to recommended project pages through contextual case-study links.

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

Blocal - Los Angeles, CA Aug 2026 - Present

UX Designer (Volunteer)

- Designing and building the website for Blocal, a Los Angeles organization.
- Facilitating workshops between graphic designers and data analysts.
- Coordinating schedules for 4 workshops with designers.

SKILLS

Design: End-to-end product design, interaction and UI design, high-fidelity prototyping, UI components, user flows, wireframing, information architecture, accessibility

Research: User interviews, usability testing, field research, research synthesis

Development: AI-assisted coding (vibe coding), React, JavaScript, HTML/CSS

Tools: Figma, Claude Code, Adobe Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign